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DJIA 47706.51 ▼ 34.29 0.07% NASDAQ 22697.10 ▲ 0.01% STOXX 600 606.12 ▲ 1.9% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 1/32, yield 4.135% OIL \$83.45 ▼ \$11.32 GOLD \$5,229.70 ▲ \$138.20 EURO \$1.1611 YEN 158.05

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **A deleted tweet** by the U.S. energy secretary whipsawed oil prices, leaving futures to settle down 12% at \$83.45 a barrel. Stocks ended mixed, with the S&P 500 and Dow falling 0.2% and less than 0.1%, respectively, while the Nasdaq rose less than 0.1%. **B1**

◆ **Aramco said it could** restore oil output within days of the Strait of Hormuz reopening, while warning of long-term harm should the waterway remain choked. **B2**

◆ **The International Energy Agency** has proposed the largest release of oil reserves in its history to bring down crude prices during the war with Iran. **A5**

◆ **Boeing said it would** delay deliveries of some 737 MAX planes after discovering a problem with wiring on newly built aircraft. **B2**

◆ **Bill Ackman filed to** take public his hedge-fund firm, Pershing Square, in tandem with a new investment fund in a bold bet to capitalize on his social-media exposure. **B1**

◆ **Home sales rose** in February, rebounding after a substantial drop the previous month as buyers seized on falling mortgage rates. **A2**

◆ **Exxon Mobil plans** to move its legal home to Texas from New Jersey, joining other companies that have relocated to the Lone Star state in search of a more business-friendly environment. **B1**

◆ **Nvidia invested in** Thinking Machines Lab, part of a multiyear partnership in which the startup will deploy at least one gigawatt of cutting-edge chips to train and serve its frontier AI models. **B4**

Worldwide

◆ **Trump's suggestions** that the war with Iran might soon be over underline the divergent views the U.S. and Israel hold on when and under what conditions the conflict could end. **A1, A5-7**

◆ **Australia issued** humanitarian visas to five members of the Iranian women's soccer team who sought refuge after the players were criticized by Iran's state media. **A7**

◆ **A federal judge** ordered states and Live Nation to try to resolve an antitrust lawsuit against the concert promoter a day after the Justice Department and the company proposed a settlement. **A3**

◆ **Novo Nordisk was** warned by the FDA for failing to report serious suspected side effects in patients who undertook the company's GLP-1 treatments. **A3**

◆ **The average American** senior's Medicare premiums last year were about 10% higher because of alleged overpayments to private Medicare Advantage plans, congressional investigators found. **A3**

◆ **The U.S. Consulate in** Toronto was hit by gunfire, Canadian authorities said, after two men in a white Honda approached the building. **A9**

◆ **Democrat Shawn Harris** and Republican Clay Fuller advanced to a runoff for Marjorie Taylor Greene's former U.S. House seat in Georgia after no candidate won a majority in a special election. **A4**

◆ **A former Syrian** air force colonel was charged in a British court with three counts of murder as a crime against humanity for attacks in a Damascus suburb in 2011. **A9**

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JULIA BENAMEREE/NIRKHS/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The body of Sgt. Benjamin Pennington, who was killed in the Iran war, was brought to Dover Air Force Base in Delaware. Vice President JD Vance, Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and Joint Chiefs of Staff Chairman Gen. Dan Caine saluted.

Grip on Strait Lets Iran Export More Oil Than Before the War

Tehran is conducting business as usual, while others in region cut their production

By BENOIT FAUCON AND COSTAS PARIS

Iran is exporting more oil through the Strait of Hormuz than before the war, showing it is in control of a strategic waterway that it has closed off to the rest of the region's oil producers.

As Gulf Arab oil producers from Saudi Arabia to Iraq cut production and scramble for new routes that bypass the

strait, Iran is conducting business as usual, according to data from tanker-tracking firm Kpler, throwing a financial lifeline to Tehran as it comes under blistering attack from the U.S. and Israel.

On Tuesday, U.S. officials said Iran placed mines in the Strait of Hormuz over recent days, an escalation that led President Trump to threaten a reprisal.

Since the war started on Feb. 28, seven tankers have loaded oil off the Iranian coast, according to Kpler, which tracks tanker traffic. Already, at least two of the most recent loadings have transited out of the Persian Gulf, Kpler said.

Mideast Fallout

- ◆ IEA proposes record oil stock release..... **A5**
- ◆ Iranian soccer players get asylum in Australia..... **A7**
- ◆ Aramco aims to restore production quickly..... **B2**
- ◆ Heard on the Street: Feast to famine in oil market... **B12**

Over the past six days, tankers have loaded a daily average of 2.1 million barrels of Iranian oil, higher than the 2 million barrels a day Iran exported in February, according to Kpler.

Iran's export levels can vary week to week, but the increase in recent days shows that, un-

like other producers, their shipments are unimpeded and that China hasn't lost its appetite for Tehran's crude.

Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps threatened to attack any ship trying to traverse the strait since the U.S. and Israel launched their airstrikes, effectively scaring off ships carrying oil and goods between the wider world and the Persian Gulf, where about one-third of global oil production takes place. Iran has fired drones and missiles at Gulf Arab oil producers and warned it would set ships crossing the strait on fire.

The crisis has sparked fears that a doomsday scenario was

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Oil Jolt Threatens Car Sales

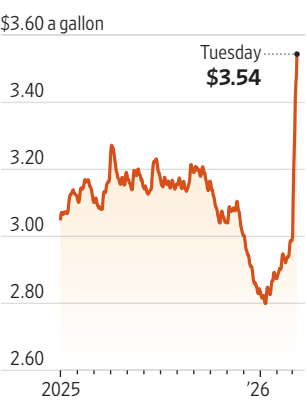
A since-deleted post by the energy secretary whipsawed oil prices Tuesday. Gasoline's price rise has carmakers worried. **B1**

U.S. crude-oil futures price



Sources: FactSet (futures); AAA data via Oil Price Information Service (gasoline)

National average price for regular unleaded gasoline



Both Adversaries Miscalculated Course of Expanding Conflict

By YAROSLAV TROFIMOV

The U.S.-Israeli war with Iran, well into its second week, has now involved at least 12 nations, with economic and political shocks reverberating around the world. Neither side has achieved its strategic objectives so far, and both boast that they can outlast the other.

If the conflict turns into a protracted war of attrition, Russia looks set to become a clear beneficiary, raking in profits from spiking oil and

natural-gas prices, while the Western economies, Gulf states and even China will all feel spreading pain.

While these are still the early days, both sides appear to have miscalculated how the other would behave, triggering an ever-expanding conflict with few clear ways out in the foreseeable future. President Trump, who spoke with President Vladimir Putin of Russia on Monday, said in a news conference that the war will be over "very soon," but followed it by saying that the

U.S. would "go further." Iran this week fired hundreds of drones and missiles across the Middle East.

Trump's hope, according to U.S. officials, was that the Feb. 28 decapitating strike on the Iranian leadership—including the killing of the country's supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei—would trigger either a collapse of the Iranian regime or the repeat of the Venezuela scenario, in which more pragmatic officials chose to cooperate with Washington.

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Teens Shake Up Market Research With a Billion-Dollar AI Startup

By SUZANNE VRANICA

AI startup Aaru's first New York headquarters had a basketball hoop and a "rage room" where employees smashed tables with a hammer after coding failures. The conference room served double duty as a co-founder's bedroom.

The space looked like a cross between a frat house and a high-tech research lab, a

fitting aesthetic for a company founded by teenagers.

Aaru recently reached a \$1 billion valuation, making it one of a growing crop of hot companies led by people who have barely cracked their 20s and want to shake up entire industries in lieu of attending college.

Co-founders Cameron Fink and Ned Koh started the company two years ago when they

were 18 and 19 years old, respectively, along with technology chief John Kessler, then 15. (Kessler isn't yet old enough to join the board, and his father had to sign off on the investment paperwork.) Their firm's work offers a window into how AI is automating labor-intensive, expensive tasks once controlled by research companies, consultants

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New York's New Superhero Makes Trash Disappear

* * *

◆ 'Trashley Madison' picks up garbage people tie to the Brooklyn Bridge ◆

By XAVIER MARTINEZ

Ellen Baum had a wine opener, a pair of gloves and a question she couldn't shake: Why was nobody cleaning up the Brooklyn Bridge?

Since early February, the 37-year-old has spent more than 40 hours cutting hair ties, tissues and receipts off the fencing—through the dead of winter, with no official

mandate and no pay. The effort has earned her a following, a city council ally and a few nicknames: Trashley Madison. Brooklyn brigante. Trash czar.

She didn't expect any of it. She especially didn't expect to wind up pitching New York City's government



Dirty work

on litter mitigation and revamping the bridge's appearance. "The Brooklyn Bridge just feels a little left behind," said Baum, a program manager who lives in nearby Brooklyn Heights.

"It's a major tourist attraction and it's a critical commuting

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Vance or Rubio In '28? Trump Can't Stop Asking

Secretary of state has been highlighted, but some see vice president as MAGA heir

WASHINGTON—Less than a day after the U.S. began bombing Iran, President Trump met with two dozen donors at his Mar-a-Lago club. As attendees dined on jumbo crab and rib-eye steaks, Trump asked the crowd: What do you think of JD Vance and Marco Rubio?

By Alex Leary, Natalie Andrews and Meredith McGraw

The guests applauded louder for Rubio, according to people in the room.

The 2028 election is more than 2½ years away, but it is very much on Trump's mind, as he casts about for a suitable heir to his MAGA empire. For months, the president has privately polled advisers, donors and friends

about the political strengths and weaknesses of his vice president and secretary of state, pitting the two young, ambitious Republicans against each other—whether they like it or not.

Increasingly, Trump has shown fondness for Rubio, according to people who have spoken to the president, praising him in private and telling associates that he thinks the former Florida senator is electable. Trump's second-term fixation on foreign policy has put Rubio, at the center of the administration's most high-profile moves, and the president often turns to Rubio for advice, the people said.

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◆ **Republicans grow nervous over war**..... **A4**

Israel, U.S. See Different Goals for Iran War

Trump says conflict could be over soon, but Netanyahu seeks a change in regime

President Trump's suggestions that the war with Iran might soon be over are bringing a new problem to the fore: Israel and the U.S. have different ideas on when to end the conflict and under what conditions.

By Anat Peled, Jared Malsin and Michael R. Gordon

Trump and Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel have spoken nearly every day since the war began. Netanyahu has also held conversations with U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio and Jared Kushner, Trump's son-in-law and envoy for Iran. All those talks center on the current state of the war and how to end it, the U.S. officials said, as both countries try to bridge their differences in real time.

There is some concern among White House officials that Israel wants the war to last after the U.S. expresses its desire to end the bombing campaign, the officials said. U.S. and Israeli officials said the Israeli message is it will stop its campaign in Iran whenever U.S. involvement stops. Trump has told aides he wants to end the war on his terms and, after brokering a cease-fire in last year's 12-day war, believes he can put a stop to the fighting when he wants, U.S. officials said.

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